MASTER FUNCTIONAL SKILLS

OFFICIAL OFQUAL SPECIFICATION • 2026/2027 CURRICULUM

LEVEL 2 MASTERY

L2 SPAG

SPELLING, PUNCTUATION & GRAMMAR MASTERY

The Complete 2-Page Spread Self-Study & Revision Workbook

Calibrated to Ofqual standards using Raymond Murphy 'Grammar in Use' pedagogy. Specially engineered with dyslexia-friendly typography, anti-glare cream canvas, and chunked cognitive layouts.

MURPHY 2-PAGE SPREADS
Visual theory on the left; progressive 4-tier practice drills on the right.

DYSLEXIA-FRIENDLY CANVAS
Soft #FDFBF7 cream background, Lexend font, and left-aligned text.

FORENSIC PROOFREADING
Authentic workplace memos, emails, and reports with exact error counts.

FULL COMPLETE ANSWER KEY
Exhaustive 4-page answers with examiner commentary and model rewrites.

PEARSON EDEXCEL • CITY & GUILDS • NCFE • HIGHFIELD

masterfunctionalskills.co.uk • Complete 100-Page Curriculum Manual

2026/2027 EDITION

SPAG LEVEL 2

Spelling, Punctuation & Grammar

Level 2 • Big rules, real workplace examples and lots of practice.

This book belongs to:	Exam date:	Target level:
_____	_____	_____

What is inside

1–13	Sentences, commas, semicolons, apostrophes	6
14–26	Verbs, agreement, homophones, spelling	32
V	Visual vocabulary: workplace words	58
M	Exam practice and mock papers	70
✓	Answers	80

How to use this book

📖 Read
Read the rule. Study the picture.

✎ Try
Write your answers on the lines.

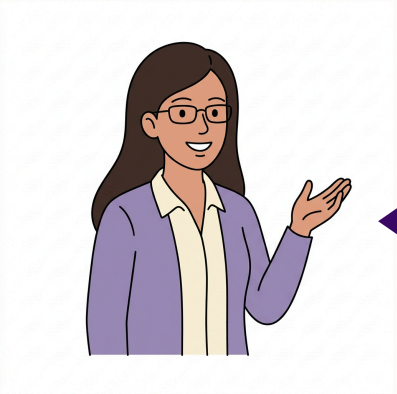
✓ Check
Mark it with the answers at the back.

★ Remember
Learn the Golden Rule by heart.

BEFORE YOU START

How a unit works

Every unit is a two-page spread. Learn on the left. Practise on the right.



Hi! I'm Priya. On the **left page** I explain one rule with a picture, a Golden Rule and a common trap to avoid.

Priya • your tutor

I'm Sam. On the **right page** I try the exercises. I write on the lines, then check the answers at the back.



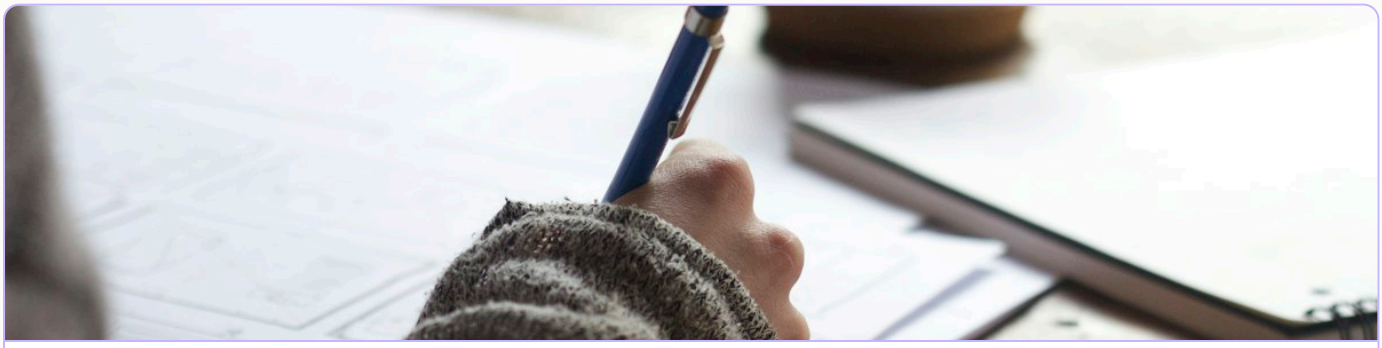
Sam • a learner like you

★ Left page = Learn

- **A** – the idea, in plain English
- **B** – the rule, step by step
- **C** – wrong vs right example

★ Right page = Practise

- **A** – tick the right answer
- **B** – rewrite the sentence
- **C** – write your own

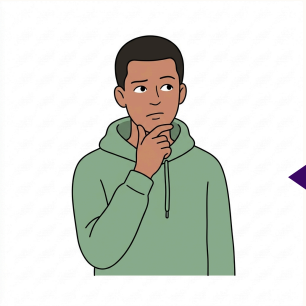


Little and often: one unit a day is better than five on a Sunday.

12

UNIT 12 • PUNCTUATION & SPELLING MECHANICS

Its or It's?



Sam

A The idea

it's is short for **it is** or **it has**.
its means **belonging to it** – like *his* or *her*. No apostrophe!

B The Decisive Test: Its vs It's

it's = it is / it has | **its = belonging to it**

Say **'it is'** out loud in the gap.

- If it makes sense, write **it's**: *It's cold in the server room.*
- If not, write **its**: *The firm changed its logo.*

The 'It Is' Mantra

If you can't say **'it is'** or **'it has'** in that spot, rub out the apostrophe.

Watch Out!

its' is never correct. It does not exist!

C × Wrong

The uninterruptible power supply failed because it's battery had reached the end of it's operational life.

✓ Right

The uninterruptible power supply failed because its battery had reached the end of its operational life.



IT technicians write reports where its / it's matters.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Identify the sentence with 100% correct usage of its and it's:

- [ ] The server cabinet lost it's cooling fan, but its still functioning.
- [ ] The server cabinet lost its cooling fan, but it's still functioning.
- [ ] The server cabinet lost its' cooling fan, but its still functioning.

2 Which sentence demonstrates correct possessive usage?

- [ ] Each workstation retains its default network security configuration.
- [ ] Each workstation retains it's default network security configuration.
- [ ] Each workstation retains its' default network security configuration.

3 Select the sentence where 'it's' correctly represents 'it has':

- [ ] It's been confirmed that the data backup was successful.
- [ ] Its been confirmed that the data backup was successful.
- [ ] Its' been confirmed that the data backup was successful.

B Rewrite it correctly

4 **Insert 'its' or 'it's':** *The enterprise software updated _____ database automatically.*

5 **Insert 'its' or 'it's':** _____ *imperative that all passwords are reset every ninety days.*

C Your turn: Write two sentences about a work computer: one with it's and one with its.

11

UNIT 11 • PUNCTUATION & SPELLING MECHANICS

Apostrophes for Owners



Priya

A The idea

An apostrophe can show that something **belongs** to someone: *the manager's office* = the office of the manager.

★ B The Three Rules of Possessive Apostrophes

one owner: 's | **plural ending in s: s'** | **plural without s: 's**

- **One** tenant → the **tenant's** lease
- **Many** tenants → the **tenants'** committee
- **Irregular** plural → the **children's** play area, the **men's** room

✓ The Cover Test

Cover the apostrophe with your finger. The word on the left must name the **owner**.

! Watch Out!

Never use an apostrophe for a simple plural: *six pallet's* × → *six pallets* ✓

C × Wrong

All contractor's must park their vehicle's in the visitors car park.

✓ Right

All contractors must park their vehicles in the visitors' car park.



Signs, notices and contracts all use possessive apostrophes.

A Tick the correct sentence

1 Which sentence demonstrates correct possession for an irregular plural noun?

- ☐ The childrens' play area must be inspected weekly.
- ☐ The children's play area must be inspected weekly.
- ☐ The childrens play area must be inspected weekly.

2 Select the sentence that avoids the disastrous 'greengrocer's apostrophe':

- ☐ The warehouse received six new pallet's yesterday.
- ☐ The warehouse received six new pallets yesterday.
- ☐ The warehouse' received six new pallets yesterday.

3 Choose the correct phrase: *'The meeting will take place in the [___] conference suite.'*

☐ clients' ☐ client's ☐ clients

B Rewrite it correctly

4 **Make singular possessive:** *The report written by the auditor was comprehensive.*

_____

_____

5 **Make plural possessive:** *The rest room designated for teachers was repainted.*

_____

_____

C Your turn: Write two rules for a staff room. Use *the manager's* and *the staff's*.

_____

_____

_____

_____

VISUAL VOCABULARY • MODULE 1

Workplace Words: Prefixes

A prefix goes at the **start** of a word and changes its meaning.



antivirus (anti- = opposed to)

Install **antivirus** software on every laptop.



bilateral (bi- = two)

The two companies signed a **bilateral** deal.



collaborate (co- / con- = together)

Our teams **collaborate** on the project.



de-escalate (de- = reverse)

Stay calm to **de-escalate** an angry customer.



forecast (fore- = before)

The sales **forecast** for May looks good.



malfunction (mal- = bad)

The printer had a **malfunction** again.



miscalculate (mis- = incorrect)

Don't **miscalculate** the delivery cost.



multidisciplinary (multi- = many)

A **multidisciplinary** NHS team met today.



subcontractor (sub- = under)

A **subcontractor** fitted the new windows.

P

PRACTICE • UNIT 12

Proofreading Challenge

Find and correct 5 its / it's errors

CloudCore Data Centre • Critical Systems Incident Report

System: Primary Hypervisor Cluster • **Incident Ref:** INC-8821

At 03:14 on Tuesday, Server Rack 4 triggered an automated alert because it's internal core temperature exceeded safe tolerances. The secondary cooling fan had lost it's power feed following a capacitor surge.

Its evident that preventive maintenance had been delayed during the previous cycle. Although the hypervisor preserved its' storage parity, database latency increased noticeably.

Its been agreed that a redundant cooling module will be commissioned immediately to ensure the server cluster maintains it's integrity.

	Error (copy it)	Correction
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

✎ The rule I used most was...

M

MOCK TASK • 15 MARKS

Exam Practice: Write an Email

Your task

You work at **Riverside Trade Park**. The car park will be closed for repairs next week.

Write an **email to all tenants** to:

- explain why the car park is closing
- say where staff can park instead
- ask tenants to tell their visitors

Use **at least two** possessive apostrophes correctly.

Plan

Plan 3 paragraphs before you write.

Check

Check every apostrophe at the end.

New message

To:

Cc:

Subject:

Greeting

Opening paragraph

Main points

Sign-off

Email layout

✎ Write your email here:

CHECK YOUR WORK

Answers

Unit 12 – Section A

1. B **2.** A **3.** A

Unit 12 – Section B

4. The enterprise software updated its database automatically.

5. It's imperative that all passwords are reset every ninety days.

Unit 11 – Section A

1. B **2.** B **3.** A

Unit 11 – Section B

4. The auditor's report was comprehensive.

5. The teachers' rest room was repainted.

Proofreading (Unit 12 memo)

- Incorrect 'it's' for possessive in paragraph 1 ('because it's internal core temperature' -> 'because its internal core temperature')
- Incorrect 'it's' for possessive in paragraph 1 ('lost it's power feed' -> 'lost its power feed')
- Missing apostrophe in contraction in paragraph 2 ('Its evident' -> 'It's evident' [It is evident])
- Fictional 'its'' form in paragraph 2 ('preserved its' storage parity' -> 'preserved its storage parity')
- Missing apostrophe in contraction ('Its been agreed' -> 'It's been agreed' [It has been agreed]) and incorrect 'it's' possessive in paragraph 3 ('maintains it's integrity' -> 'maintains its integrity')

Prefix check

anti = against • bi = two • co = together • de = reverse • fore = before • mal = bad • mis = wrongly • multi = many • sub = under

✎ My corrections – what will I do differently next time?

Conquer Spelling, Punctuation and Grammar once and for all

Up to 42% of marks in Functional Skills English Writing depend on SPaG accuracy. This definitive handbook breaks down every essential rule into digestible, memorable formulas with high-impact before-and-after corrections.

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978-1-912345-85-2